

Politics of Treachery

H.D. Kumaraswamy must realise that blatant opportunism and unethical ways will only accelerate his fall ("Double Trouble", October 8). After cheating BJP, he must not remain under the illusion that his image of a simple villager will stay. The public cannot be taken for granted.

V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

Former prime minister H.D. Deve Gowda's affection for son Kumaraswamy shows that there are many Dhritrashtra in Indian politics.

SHIV SHANKER ALMAL, *Kolkata*

Not an Ideal Idol

The democratic way of selecting talent has so far fetched only revenue ("Real Politics", October 8). It is yet to produce real talent since voting—based on caste, religion and region—can never be a measure of anybody's competence.

SANJAY SHARMA, *Bangalore*

Incredibly Young India

Compared to the UK and the US which have had been democratic forms of government for five and two centuries, respectively, India is still a fledgling trying to walk ("Snapshots of Change", October 1). Yet it is now threatening to overtake the two countries in every field. What has made such a huge difference is the youth, which has so far successfully balanced modernity with tradition.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

Leaders of Backwardness

Whatever progress the country has made has not been due to the politicians but despite them ("Leaders Lead, Laggards Lag", September 24). Most of them are interested in earning money as soon as possible, by employing any means.

HARISH DESAI, *Junagadh*

It is distressing to see that Karnataka, whose capital Bangalore is called the

Silicon Valley of India and which has brought prosperity to the state, is still languishing at the seventh position, far below Punjab and Haryana. The reason for this is not far to seek. The state's politicians have been far too busy protesting, organising strikes and quarrelling with each other and with neighbouring states. They have no time to spare for the state's development.

S.N. SURYA, *Mysore*

GOD'S OWN CONTROVERSY



M. Karunanidhi may not believe in Lord Ram's existence, but he has no right to force others into agreeing with him by resorting to measures like strikes ("In Ram's Name", October 1).

P.B. MENON, *Mumbai*

The Ram Sethu controversy is as bizarre as the screenplays Karunanidhi has written in his film career. First came the ASI's affidavit voicing its opinion on a matter it was not competent to comment on. Then came the sardonic comments by the Kalaingar regarding Ram's professional training. Obviously, such a drama has been played to strengthen the anti-Brahmin votebank.

K.R. RAVI, *USA*

Would Karunanidhi dare talk ill of Islam and Christianity as he does with Hinduism?

M.M. KALE, *on e-mail*

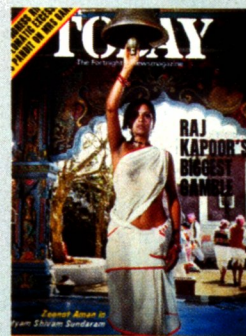
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Years Ago in India Today

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Dissent and Discontent

For over a month now, Bangladesh has been witnessing a series of violent and unsettling events which have made President Zia-ur-Rehman's two-year-old military rule in the country highly insecure. The mutiny by armoured and infantry men of over a battalion strength at Bogra cantonment on

September 30 and the abortive coup in Dacca on October 2 have been, by far, the most serious attempts to dislodge the President from power. The recent incidents have not only given a severe jolt to the "supreme authority" of President Zia, who simultaneously holds the three important posts in the country—that of the President, Chief of the Army Staff and Chief Martial Law Administrator—but have underscored the existence of rampant indiscipline and sharp divisions within the Bangladesh armed forces.

—Manash Ghosh